me that sometimes there are things going on that only the top person in the government knows about, and I thought it was best for me to keep quiet; there might be something going on I didn't know about.

But I wasn't happy with the events in Iran. The sudden emergence of fanatic Islamic fundamentalism as a political force in the Middle East was a development that would have posed a difficult challenge to any Western leader concerned with our strategic interests there. It wasn't an easy situation for Carter to deal with, and he couldn't be faulted for the awakening of this dark and fanatical force.

But I felt that by standing by and failing to come up with a viable alternative to deal with the crisis when the Shah of Iran was forced from power in early 1979, the Carter administration had sown the seeds of the foreign policy disaster that would later engulf it.

I was told by officials of the Shah's government that after rioting began in the streets of Teheran in 1979, the Shah's advisors told him if they were allowed to arrest five hundred people—the most corrupt businessmen and officials in the government—the revolutionary fires could be extinguished, and they could head off the revolution.

But people in the American Embassy told the Shah to do nothing, and he didn't. Until the very end, he kept telling his staff, "The United States has always been our friend and it won't let me down now." Well, he took our advice on how to respond to the mobs and when he had to flee his country, the United States didn't even want to let him in for the medical care that he desperately needed. It was terrible treatment for a man who had been our friend and solid ally for more than thirty-five years.

Yes, there had been serious human rights abuses under the Shah. But he had done many good and progressive things for his country; he had brought it into the twentieth century, and in the years preceding his downfall, the Shah